CYBERSECURITY AWARENESS

Mastering Phishing Defense

Recognize deceptive tactics, protect sensitive data, and respond effectively to digital threats.

Information Security Training • 10 Essential Modules

ATTACK LIFECYCLE

How Phishing Works

1. The Bait

Attacker sends deceptive message imitating trusted authority.

2. The Action

Victim clicks fraudulent link or opens infected attachment.

3. The Compromise

Credentials stolen or malware installed on enterprise system.

ATTACK VECTORS

Common Phishing Variants

Email Phishing

Broad-scale automated blasts harvesting generic credentials.

Spear Phishing

Customized attacks targeted at specific roles and executives.

Smishing

Mobile SMS lures masquerading as bank or package delivery alerts.

Quishing

Malicious QR codes bypassing traditional email link filters.

THREAT DETECTION

Warning Signs in Emails

Artificial Urgency

Demands immediate action within 24 hours to prevent account lockout.

Unexpected Attachments

Unsolicited ZIP, ISO, or macro-enabled documents labeled as invoices.

Spoofed Sender Domains

Subtle typosquatting such as company-support.co instead of official domain.

Unusual Requests

Bypasses standard approval protocol for gift cards, wires, or credentials.

DOMAIN INSPECTION

How to Spot Fake Websites

Inspection Checkpoint	Legitimate Web Portal	Fraudulent Phish Site
Domain Root	portal.microsoft.com	microsoft.portal-verify.com
URL Spelling	Accurate brand spelling	Typos: rn for m, or 1 for l
SSL Certificate	Valid organization certificate	Mismatched name or browser warning
Authentication	Enterprise Single Sign-On (SSO)	Isolated, unexpected password prompts

PSYCHOLOGICAL TRIGGERS

The 5 Pillars of Social Engineering

Fear

Threats of legal penalty or immediate termination.

Urgency

Artificial deadlines bypassing critical scrutiny.

Authority

Impersonating C-suite executives and IT directors.

Curiosity

Teasers regarding layoffs, bonuses, or payroll leaks.

Impersonation

Cloning vendor logos, email footers, and signatures.

CASE STUDY BREAKDOWN

Anatomy of a Fake HR Email

From: HR Benefits
To: staff-all@enterprise.com
Subject: URGENT: Annual Benefit Re-enrollment Window Closes in 4 Hours

All employees must immediately confirm medical coverage details. Failure to verify credentials today will terminate active benefits.

Verify Benefits Login Now

FLAG 1: LOOKALIKE DOMAIN
Domain differs from legitimate corporate directory.

FLAG 2: 4-HOUR DEADLINE
Extreme time crunch created to trigger panic.

FLAG 3: GENERIC BROAD BLAST
No employee name, ID, or department specified.

DEFENSE PROTOCOL

How to Stay Safe

Verify Out-of-Band

Confirm unexpected financial or HR requests via direct phone call.

Enforce Strong MFA

Use authenticator apps or FIDO keys to neutralize password theft.

Report Suspicious Mail

Forward questionable emails to the dedicated security operations mailbox.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

Interactive Quiz: 5 Threat Checks

Q1	Urgent password reset link received by email?	**Do not click • Go to portal directly**
Q2	Domain displays company-support.cloud?	**Fake lookalike • Report immediately**
Q3	SMS text alerts of held postal delivery?	**Smishing scam • Delete message**
Q4	Parking meter sticker covered by QR code?	**Quishing hazard • Use official meter**
Q5	Accidentally entered password on unfamiliar site?	**Reset password • Alert IT security now**

SUMMARY & INCIDENT RESPONSE

When in Doubt, Verify and Report

Speed matters. Timely reporting protects not just your own account, but the entire enterprise network.

Internal Phishing Inbox
phish-report@organization.com

Emergency SecOps Hotline
Extension 4433 (24/7)